

Assignment 4-

Usability testing and analysis

GROCERY STORE STOCK
TRACKER Website

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1. Introduction

Once the prototype was ready, I ran a usability testing session on the Inventory Management System to see how it actually held up with real users. The focus was on the core workflows — navigating the app, checking inventory records, digging into product details, adding new items, and pulling up reports.

The point wasn't just to confirm that buttons work. It was to understand how users think when they're moving through the system, where things feel natural, and where the design might be getting in their way without me realizing it.

2. Test plan

Objective

Evaluate how well the prototype supports real inventory management tasks — and find the gaps before they become bigger problems down the line.

Method

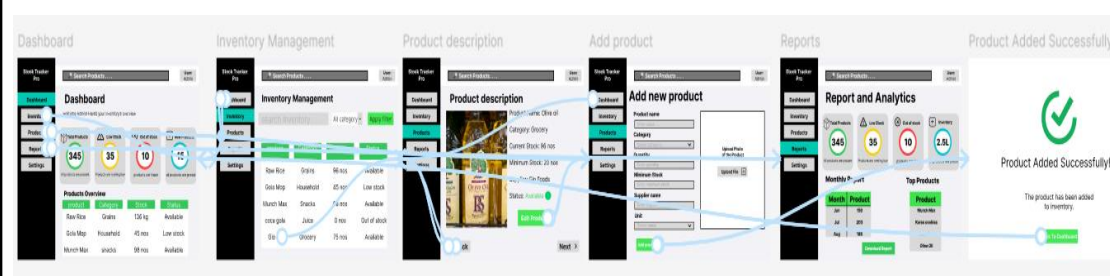
Moderated usability testing using the interactive Figma prototype. I sat in on each session, watched how participants navigated, and took notes on where things clicked and where they didn't.

Participants

Three people joined the session, each coming from a different angle:

- **Participant 1** — Store Manager
- **Participant 2** — Inventory Staff
- **Participant 3** — General User

Having a mix of backgrounds was intentional — an inventory system needs to work for the person managing it daily, not just someone familiar with the design.



3. What they were asked to do

Each participant was given six tasks to complete on their own:

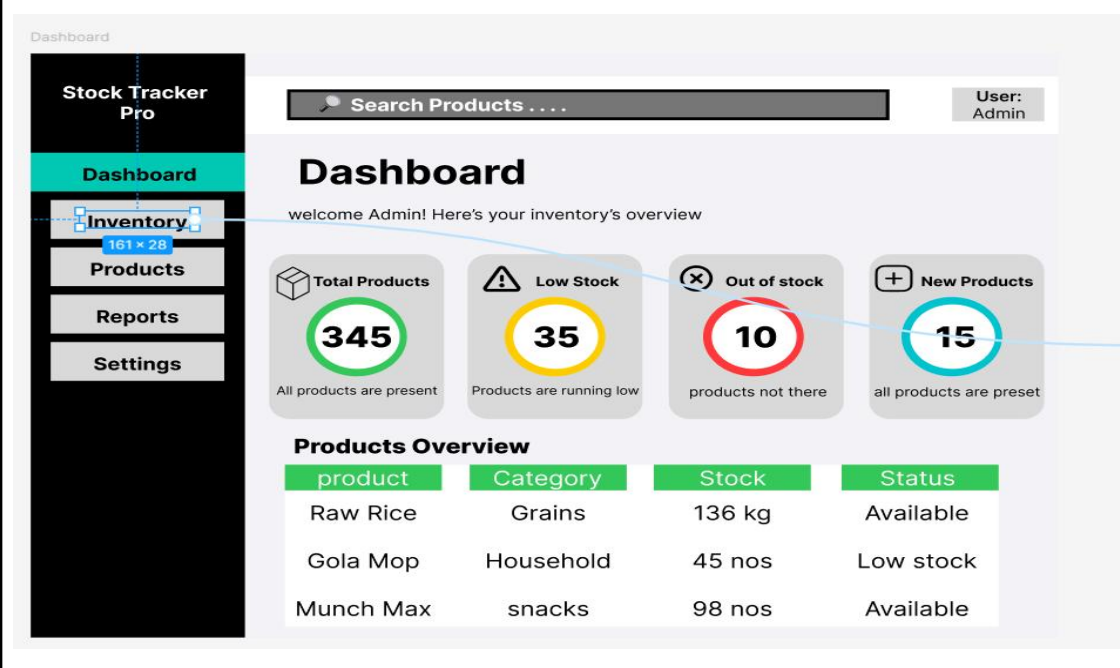
1. Check the inventory statistics on the Dashboard
2. Navigate to the Inventory Management page
3. Open the details for a specific product
4. Add a new product using the Add Product form
5. Access the Reports & Analytics section
6. Navigate back to the Dashboard

No guidance, no walkthroughs — just them working through it naturally.

4. Results

Every single task was completed successfully by all three participants:

Task	Success Rate
View dashboard statistics	3/3
Navigate to inventory page	3/3
View product details	3/3
Add new product	3/3
Access report and analytics	3/3
Retrun to dashboard	3/3



Nobody got lost, nobody needed a hint. Users picked up the workflow pretty quickly and moved through the app without much hesitation. That was genuinely good to see, especially with participants who weren't designers.

5. What users said

Participant 1 (Store Manager)

Found the Dashboard clear and easy to read — said they could get a full picture of stock status without having to dig around for it. That "at a glance" quality was something they specifically appreciated.

Participant 2 (Inventory Staff)

Thought the product management flow was logical and didn't feel overcomplicated. Also found the search functionality useful — said it saved time compared to scrolling through a long list.

Participant 3 (General User)

Had no trouble finding the Reports section, which was actually a concern going in. Also noted that the sidebar navigation felt consistent throughout the app, which made moving around less confusing.

6. Key findings

A few clear patterns came out across all three sessions:

- The Dashboard layout was intuitive — users knew what they were looking at immediately
- Inventory information was well-organized and easy to scan without feeling overwhelming
- Product management tasks (viewing, adding, editing) all went smoothly end to end
- The Reports section delivered what users expected and was easy to get to
- The sidebar navigation was a genuine usability win — consistent, accessible, and predictable

7. Usability Metrics

Metric	Success Rate
Task completion rate	100%
Navigation success rate	100%
User satisfaction	High
Error rate	Low

Clean results across the board. For a first round of testing, this was a strong baseline to work from.

8. What could Be Better

Even with solid results, a few things came up worth addressing in the next version:

- **Color-coded status badges** — Low stock and out-of-stock items need to stand out more visually; right now they blend in too much
- **Better filtering and sorting** — Users wanted more control over how they view and sort inventory lists
- **Richer analytics charts** — The reports section works, but adding visual charts would make the data much easier to interpret quickly
- **Low-stock alerts** — An automated notification when something drops below minimum threshold would save a lot of manual checking
- **Export options** — Users expected to be able to download inventory data or reports; that's a pretty standard feature for this kind of tool

9. Recommendations

Based on what came out of testing, here's what I'd prioritize for the next design iteration:

- Make inventory status more visually obvious — badges, colors, icons
- Build out search and filtering so users can slice the data the way they need to
- Add charts and visual summaries to the analytics section

- Implement automated stock alerts so nothing slips through the cracks
- Keep running feedback sessions — one round of testing gives you a starting point, not a finish line

10. **Conclusion**

The testing went well. All three participants — including a store manager and inventory staff member who use these kinds of tools professionally — completed every task without needing help. The feedback was positive and specific, which is more useful than vague approval.

The prototype clearly does its core job. But the findings also point to some real, concrete improvements that would take it from functional to genuinely great. The foundation is solid; now it's about building on it with the right details.